Indian nation continued in this way, Hindu civilisation would perish. This is what had happened, after all, to Greece and Egypt, whose modern incarnations bore no relationship to the ancient civilisations from which they claimed descent. The same stock of people might be living in those countries, but they bore no resemblance to their glorious past civilisations or forebears. Indeed, the essence of their society, its identity, had changed. This was the fate that Upadhyaya feared would befall India if it continued down the secular Westernised path charted for it in its Constitution: it would lose its core identity (which lay in the form of its *chiti*) and in effect become something other than the continuing Bharatiya civilisation that could trace its origins back to the mists of time.

Deen Dayal Upadhyaya, contra Savarkar and Golwalkar, accepted that the India of which he was writing had to accommodate its Muslims and Christians too. He rejected the notion that the Hindu Rashtra would have to mean 'a theocratic State propagating the Hindu religion'. Upadhyaya was conscious that his critics associated the very establishment of such a Hindu state with a revival of the ritualism associated with the Hindu religion, notions of casteism and inflexible social hierarchy, and the return of discrimination and social inequality. No, he insisted: his Hindu Rashtra was not based on hatred against any community, nor was it reactionary. Rather, his Hinduism would be inclusive.

As a Hindu, Upadhyaya averred that he was not opposed to the Muslim and Christian modes of worship; indeed he never criticised the Prophets of either faith. He believed that how to worship God, and which God to worship, was each person's personal choice; the state had no role in such considerations. His quarrel, he explained, was not with any sect or mode of worship: it was purely political.

Upadhyaya said that he respected other religions, while arguing that the problem of Muslims and Christians was not religious. Gandhiji had tried religious syncretism, singing bhajan*s* to the effect that Ishwar and Allah were the same, but political unity between the two communities had not followed. The issue therefore was one of political commitment to the country and its values, not with the practice of religious faith or with the goodness of any individual.